

Mid Green - Sustainable/Circular Systemic Change

Complex

These involve uncertainty, emergence, and dynamic relationships where outcomes can't be predicted, and solutions must evolve through experimentation.

- Redesign operations around regenerative or value-driven principles
- Facilitate negotiation between conflicting departments (e.g., logistics vs procurement)
- Navigate trade-offs between environmental/social impact and commercial return
- Design systems for reverse logistics, reuse, or closed-loop material flows
- Co-develop multi-stakeholder infrastructure investments (e.g., biogas hubs)

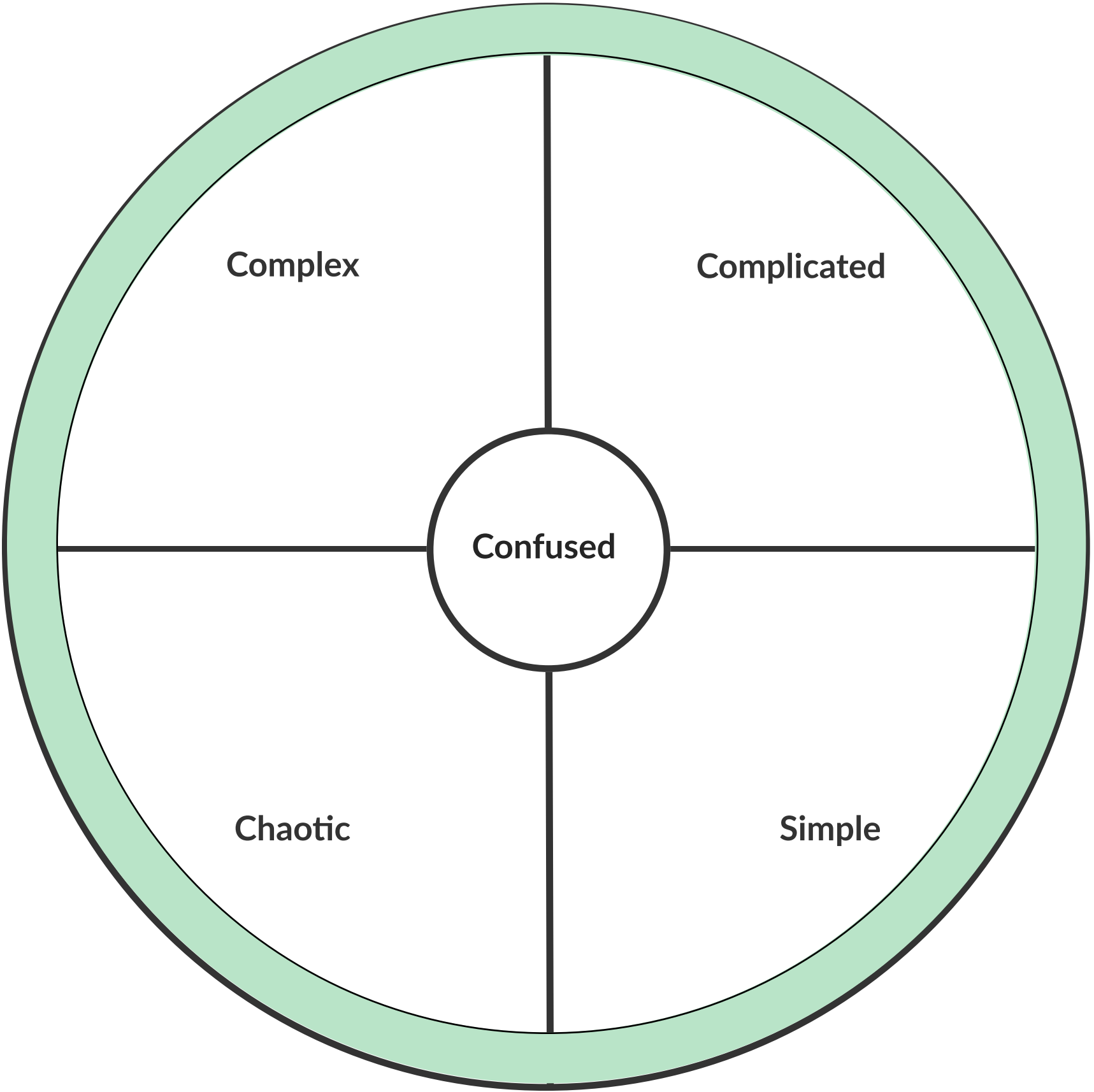
Chaotic

These are crisis or disruption scenarios where traditional decision-making fails; immediate stabilisation is needed before sense-making can begin.

- Deal with strategic contradictions where financial goals sabotage sustainability progress
- Respond rapidly to client losses triggered by failure to meet ESG expectations
- React to sudden, unplanned supply chain collapses due to external shocks

Sustainable/Systemic Changes

- Business model
- Circular value chain
- Stakeholder collaboration



Confused/Disorder

This reflects situations of ambiguity where the appropriate domain isn't clear and multiple interpretations may compete; action is delayed due to confusion.

- No agreed language or unified strategic direction around sustainability
- Incoherent cross-team communication leading to friction or inaction
- Misaligned or competing narratives between partners blocking joint progress

Complicated

These involve expert-driven processes where the solution is knowable but requires analysis, planning, or specialised insight.

- Integrate ESG KPIs into company-wide dashboards and metrics
- Run structured cross-functional ESG working groups
- Conduct financial modelling for transitioning to service-based or circular models
- Source viable low-impact materials or regional suppliers
- Negotiate sustainability target alignment with external partners or clients

Simple (Clear)

These are best practices with established procedures that can be standardised and replicated easily within organisations.

- Update organisational charts to include sustainability-specific roles
- Assign departmental sustainability responsibilities with clear remits
- Introduce ESG-aligned KPIs into team scorecards
- Pilot obvious sustainability upgrades (e.g., recyclable packaging, EVs)
- Join local sustainability coalitions or industry working groups